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MOHAMED PRESENTS ZAYED AWARD FOR HUMAN FRATERNITY

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan presents the Zayed Award For Human Fraternity to Ilham Aliyev, President of Azerbaijan (left), and Nikol Pashinyan, Prime Minister of Armenia, for the Azerbaijan-Armenia Peace Agreement, during the Zayed Award For Human Fraternity 2026, at The Founders Memorial on Wednesday.



Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

HAMDAN AWARDS GLOBAL TEACHER PRIZE TO INDIAN

Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council, presents the \$1 million Global Teacher Prize to Indian teacher Rouble Nagi, as GEMS Education founder Sunny Varkey looks on, at the World Governments Summit yesterday. **SEE ALSO P4**

BUSINESS

Sharp sell-off in AI-linked tech stocks erases more than \$1tr in market value | P-1

IN FOCUS

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FRIDAY

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US, Russia renew military contacts in UAE

RUSSIA-UKRAINE PRISONER SWAP UNFOLDS IN ABU DHABI ALONGSIDE DIPLOMATIC BREAKTHROUGH

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N.R.
Senior Associate Editor

Russia and Ukraine have carried out a prisoner exchange mediated in Abu Dhabi, while the United States and Russia held direct military-to-military talks in the UAE capital for the first time in five years — twin developments underscoring Abu Dhabi's growing role as a hub for high-level diplomacy.

The prisoner swap saw detainees from both Moscow and Kyiv return home following negotiations facilitated by the UAE, in what officials described as a rare humanitarian breakthrough amid the ongoing war.

During three-way talks in Abu

Dhabi, the sides exchanged 157 captured soldiers and civilians each, marking the first such exchange since October.

"Today's exchange came after a long pause, and it is critical that we were able to make it happen," Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky said in a social media post, thanking those involved in making the deal possible.

First exchange in 5 months

US envoy Steve Witkoff later confirmed the scale of the swap, saying: "Today, delegations from the United States, Ukraine and Russia agreed to exchange 314 prisoners — the first such exchange in five months."

"There is definitely progress. Things are moving forward in a good, positive direction," Wit-

The resumption of US-Russia military contacts is seen as particularly significant after a five-year freeze, with experts long warning that the absence of communication channels increases the risk of miscalculation.

koff added. Shortly after the exchange, senior US and Russian military officials met face to face to discuss risk reduction, communication channels and ways to avoid unintended escalation between the two nuclear powers — marking their first direct talks since 2021.

The meeting came just hours after the expiration of the last remaining US-Russia nuclear arms control pact, the New START Treaty. Officials on both sides said the discussions focused on restor-

ing basic lines of contact between defence establishments at a time of heightened global tensions.

'Constructive, professional'

The talks were described as "constructive" and "professional," underscoring the importance of dialogue despite strained political relations.

The back-to-back developments have reinforced Abu Dhabi's reputation as a trusted neutral venue for sensitive negotiations between rival powers. The re-

sumption of US-Russia military contacts is seen as particularly significant after a five-year freeze, with experts long warning that the absence of communication channels increases the risk of miscalculation.

Meanwhile, the Russia-Ukraine prisoner exchange is being viewed as a rare confidence-building step in a conflict that has seen limited diplomatic progress.

Despite the positive momentum, officials stressed that major breakthroughs remain unlikely in the near term.

Still, the willingness of opposing sides to engage — and to do so in Abu Dhabi — offers a glimpse of diplomacy continuing to function in an increasingly polarised world.

SEE ALSO P10

UAE showcases world's largest AI chip with 4 trillion transistors

Saif unveils revolutionary chip co-developed by Abu Dhabi's G42

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

The UAE has positioned itself at the forefront of artificial intelligence innovation with the unveiling of the world's largest AI chip, featuring an unprecedented four trillion transistors packed onto a single wafer.

Lt General Sheikh Saif Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Interior, introduced the groundbreaking technology during a session at the World Governments Summit in Dubai yesterday, marking a significant milestone in the nation's AI ambitions.

The revolutionary chip has been developed by G42, the Abu Dhabi-based technology holding group, and Cerebras Systems, a pioneer in accelerating generative AI. G42 group CEO Peng Xiao demonstrated the massive semiconductor to



Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

Sheikh Saif receives the chip from a robot at the World Governments Summit yesterday.

attendees. "There are over 4 trillion transistors in this chip. That's 4,000 billion transistors on a single chip," Xiao announced, holding up the wafer for the audience to see.

The chip will be deployed across G42's ambitious 5-giga-watt UAE-US AI campus in Abu Dhabi.

Powerful message

Sheikh Saif also delivered a powerful message to citizens and residents including millionaires relocating to the UAE every day: "Do not worry. Your family, your faith, your indus-

try, and your wealth are secure. You are safe, within the unbreakable fortress of the UAE," he said.

He outlined three fundamental pillars that make the UAE fortress unbreakable: industry and technological leadership; comprehensive deterrence and integration; and above all, a cohesive family and noble values. "The strength of fortresses does not lie in stones and building materials alone; it lies in their leadership and in the people who fortified them and were fortified by them," he added.

SEE ALSO P4

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